Don’t Let Gen AI Limit Your Team’s Creativity

Kian Gohar & Jeremy Utley — Harvard Business Review (Mar–Apr 2024, F2402A)

■ Core Thesis

Generative AI can accelerate brainstorming—but when used uncritically, it narrows creativity. Teams that treat AI as an oracle get average answers; those that treat it as a conversation partner achieve richer, more original results.

■ Research Overview

Four-company experiment (US & Europe) with 60 employees per firm solving real business challenges. Teams using AI generated slightly more ideas but fewer high-quality ones, showing how overreliance on AI reduces creative variance.

Measure	AI Teams vs Control	Insight
Idea quantity	+8%	AI boosts idea count slightly.
High-quality ideas	–2%	Slight creativity decline due to convergence.
Poor ideas	–7%	AI filters out bad ideas but limits novelty.
Confidence	+21%	False confidence from polished but shallow output.

■ Why Teams Underperformed

• Generic prompts produced average, statistically common ideas.
• Teams accepted AI’s first outputs, showing premature convergence.
• Few teams iterated critically with the AI to challenge results.
• False confidence made teams believe quality improved when it hadn’t.

■ Prescriptions for Creative Success

Principle	Practical Action
Define specific problems	Frame detailed, data-rich prompts to avoid generic AI results.
Start with human ideation	Brainstorm individually before using AI to expand options.
Train the AI contextually	Feed it domain data, customer insights, and prior lessons.
Dialogue, don’t delegate	Treat AI as a sparring partner through iterative conversation.
Facilitate synthesis	Use moderation to ensure idea diversity and balance.

■■ Practitioner Insight — Joe Riesberg (CIO, EMC Insurance)

“The more you question generative AI, the better its answers will be.” Initial responses tend to be logical rather than creative. Teams that persist through multiple prompt iterations unlock deeper and more original insights.

■ Placement in Compendium

Section: Human–AI Collaboration and Innovation
Subsection: Creative Intelligence & Design Thinking
Use Case: Structuring AI-assisted ideation workflows to maximize originality while avoiding average outcomes.

■ Key Takeaways

- AI boosts idea volume but can suppress creativity.
- Treat AI as a collaborator, not a content generator.
- Iteration and specificity are key to unlocking creative value.
- Human facilitation ensures diversity of thought and originality.

“Brainstorming with GenAI requires rethinking your ideation workflow. Approach it as a structured, ongoing conversation—and you’ll unlock truly creative outcomes.”

AI-Driven Process Redesign – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘The Secret to Successful AI-Driven Process Redesign’ (H. James Wilson & Paul Daugherty, 2025).

1. The Core Idea

Generative AI is enabling a modern form of kaizen — continuous improvement driven by all employees, not just technologists. Rather than replacing humans, AI is moving them to the centre of machine-assisted transformation.

2. How Generative AI Enables Kaizen 2.0

Domain	Example	Value Created
Manufacturing	Mercedes-Benz’s MO360 platform gives shop-floor workers real-time production data and	Democratizes data use, raises transparency and
Industrial Operations	Mahindra & Mahindra employees use AI assistants for robotic repairs.	Cuts downtime, boosts morale.
Pharma & Science	Merck uses generative models for synthetic defect images;	Reduces waste >50%;
Creative & Product Design	Colgate, Nestlé, and Coca-Cola use AI for product ideation and visuals; NASA engineers	Compresses design cycles;
Physical & Healthcare Systems	Symbotic’s PickGPT and digital-twin hospitals enable natural-language control and simulation	Democratizes automation; supports real-time

3. From Tools to Autonomous Agents

AI is evolving from decision-support to goal-oriented autonomy. Agents act independently to meet objectives, reason logically, plan, and learn from outcomes. Major firms such as Walmart, Marriott, Nestlé, ADT, Toyota, and JPMorgan Chase are piloting such systems.

4. Ecosystems of Agents

Complex processes increasingly depend on teams of cooperating agents, each specialised in a task. Research shows multimodal models can outperform traditional RPA, achieving 93% step identification and 90% workflow precision.

5. Strategic Takeaways for AI Leaders

• Empower everyone – make AI tools accessible via natural-language interfaces.
• Marry human intuition and AI reasoning – AI extends, not replaces, judgment.
• Use autonomous agents for routine complexity, not human creativity.
• Build learning ecosystems – human-agent collaboration compounds improvement.
• Retain a human-centred philosophy – humans define purpose, ethics, and context.

6. Consultant’s Perspective

“Continuous improvement in the age of AI depends on continuous collaboration between humans and machines.”

Consultancies should frame AI process-redesign programmes as Kaizen 2.0 transformations — fusing human empowerment, AI augmentation, and emergent autonomy.

Process Management and AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How to Marry Process Management and AI’ (Thomas H. Davenport & Thomas C. Redman, 2025).

1. The Central Idea

AI and process management must evolve together. AI alone doesn’t transform performance — it improves narrow tasks. Process management alone can stagnate — it struggles to scale. Together, they create a virtuous cycle of better data, faster change, and sustained productivity.

2. Why It Matters

• Most firms have invested heavily in AI and analytics without measurable ROI.
• Traditional process approaches (TQM, Six Sigma, Lean, Reengineering) have lost popularity due to poor change management and siloed structures.
• New technologies—AI, process mining, digital twins, and automation—make process improvement easier, faster, and data-driven.

3. How AI and Process Management Reinforce Each Other

Role	Contribution	Impact
Process Management	Provides structure, ownership, and clarity of outcomes.	Enables AI deployment at scale.
AI Technologies	Automate subprocesses, surface inefficiencies, and generate insights.	Accelerate process redesign and decision-mak
Mutual Benefit	Shared data standards across functions feed AI and make processes measurable.	Eliminates silos, improves visibility, builds conti

4. Seven Steps to Integration

Step	Description	AI’s Role
1. Establish Ownership	Appoint cross-functional process owners with end-to-end accountability.	AI dashboards and digital twins provide visibility and
2. Identify Process Customers	Define who benefits (internal/external) and their priorities.	Generative AI analyses customer feedback to detec
3. Map Existing Processes	Use flowcharts or process mining to uncover inefficiencies.	AI-driven process mining (e.g., Celonis) identifies b
4. Set Performance Metrics	Define success measures like cycle time, satisfaction, and accuracy.	Predictive analytics simulate outcomes and improve
5. Select Process Enablers	Deploy RPA, ML, IoT, and blockchain where suitable.	Generative AI automates documentation, contracts,
6. Redesign Processes	Cross-functional redesign based on insights and new technical capabilities.	AI-assisted design tools suggest optimised workflow
7. Implement & Monitor	Integrate systems, retrain staff, and institutionalize continuous improvement.	AI-powered process mining tracks variation and per

5. Global Illustrations

Company	Focus	Results
Mars Wrigley	Digital twin, decision intelligence, smart logistics	Reduced waste, improved fulfilment, higher custo

Siemens, BMW, Reckitt	IT-enabled process standardization	Global efficiency and faster order-to-cash cycles
PepsiCo	AI-based process mining for payables	Reduced write-offs and manual workload
Deutsche Telekom	AI-assisted HR process redesign	Streamlined 250 HR processes, improved satisfa

6. Consultant’s Insights

• AI amplifies process management, it doesn’t replace it.
• Process ownership and cross-functional collaboration are essential.
• Process mining and generative AI are the new levers of transformation.
• Cultural and managerial alignment — not technology — is the hardest part.
• Continuous improvement must be reimagined as AI-augmented governance.

7. Key Takeaway

“The reasons to employ process management are greater — and the difficulties smaller — than ever before.”

For AI strategists and consultants: put process at the heart of AI transformation. It’s the mechanism by which value is delivered, measured, and continuously improved.

Keep Your AI Projects on Track – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Keep Your AI Projects on Track’ (Iavor Bojinov, 2023).

1. The Core Insight

Most AI projects fail — with estimated failure rates near 80%. To succeed, organisations must professionalise Data Science & AI Operations, treating AI projects as strategic products, not experiments. The author proposes a five-step lifecycle: Selection → Development → Evaluation → Adoption → Management.

2. Step 1: Selection

AI project selection requires balancing strategic impact and feasibility, with attention to ethics and organisational readiness.

Key Dimension	What to Consider	Example / Guidance
Strategic Alignment	Align AI projects with business goals; embed data scientists in BU teams.	P&G embeds data scientists with business teams.
Measurable Impact	Define value in quantifiable 'if–then–by–because' terms.	Encourages hypothesis-driven decision-making.
Augment vs Replace	Decide whether AI complements or replaces human judgment.	Automate low-cost errors; augment high-stakes ta
Problem Suitability	Is this a problem AI can solve (structured, data-rich)?	AI predicts but doesn’t reason or empathise.
Data Readiness	Data must be sufficient, clean, fresh, and representative.	Poor data = poor model = failed project.
Technical Feasibility	Infrastructure, compute, and skills must be in place.	Requires strong data engineering backbone.
Ethical Considerations	Address bias, privacy, transparency before launch.	Apply 'privacy by design' and fairness audits.

3. Step 2: Development

Once approved, build AI as a product, not a model. Create a centre of excellence to manage data, governance, and reusable tools. Develop an 'AI Factory' pipeline for model training, validation, and deployment. Address ethical issues and leverage generative AI tools (e.g., GitHub Copilot) to boost productivity.

4. Step 3: Evaluation

AI systems must undergo scientific validation. Use A/B testing or switchback experiments to measure impact. Common causes of failure include data mismatch, feedback loops, and system drift. Continuous monitoring and early-stopping algorithms help detect harmful effects quickly.

5. Step 4: Adoption

Adoption depends on trust — in the algorithm, the developer, and the process.

Trust Pillar	Barrier	Consultant’s Recommendation
Algorithm	Users don’t understand AI or fear bias.	Explain assumptions, data, and use cases transparen

Developer	Users fear job loss or poor alignment with needs.	Involve users early; co-develop to build ownership.
Process	Users fear accountability for AI mistakes.	Establish review boards, feedback loops, and escalati

6. Step 5: Management

AI systems require ongoing stewardship. Continuously monitor performance, retrain models, and conduct AI audits for bias and ethical lapses. Treat AI management as an iterative lifecycle — gather data, retrain, redeploy, and revalidate continuously.

7. Consultant's Perspective

• AI project success = 20% technology, 80% disciplined process.
• Embed AI operations in enterprise governance.
• Balance innovation speed with ethical and human oversight.
• Build trust early — before deployment.
• Manage AI products like living systems — continuously adapting.

8. Key Takeaway

"The five-step lifecycle—selection, development, evaluation, adoption, and management—turns AI from a risky experiment into a repeatable business capability."

For consultants and AI leaders: Build AI process discipline into every engagement. Success depends less on data science brilliance and more on structured execution and trust management.

Helping Employees Succeed with Generative AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Helping Employees Succeed with Generative AI’ by Paul Leonardi (2023).

1. The Central Challenge

Generative AI evolves continuously, changing how work is done and what jobs require. Leaders must manage continuous technological change, not episodic adoption. Leonardi proposes the STEP Framework—Segmentation, Transition, Education, Performance—to help employees thrive alongside AI.

2. STEP Framework Overview

Stage	Focus	Key Insight
Segmentation	Identify which tasks AI should automate, augment, or avoid.	Employees should lead classification to build ownershi
Transition	Redesign roles after automation or augmentation.	Freed capacity enables role deepening or upgrading.
Education	Build a culture of continuous reskilling.	Ongoing AI literacy ensures sustained productivity.
Performance	Redefine metrics to reward learning and collaboration.	Short cycles with peer feedback replace annual review

3. STEP in Practice

Case studies from HealthCo, MarkCo, and UrbanGov illustrate each STEP phase in action.

Segmentation: Employees classified tasks into what AI should automate, augment, or avoid. HealthCo’s pilots freed 5 hours/week per employee while increasing engagement because staff owned the process.

Transition: Redefining roles to deepen or upgrade work responsibilities.

Type	Example	Effect
Deepening roles	MarkCo’s juniors used AI for routine collateral, freeing time for analysis.	Increased analytical capability without hiring.
Upgrading roles	UrbanGov planners automated modelling and began scenario planning.	Elevated junior contribution and redeployed senior

Education: Continuous learning as the norm. HealthCo ran quarterly AI boot camps; MarkCo partnered with a university; UrbanGov allocated 3 hours/week for learning. Employees in structured programs were 30% less likely to leave.

Performance: Firms replaced annual appraisals with short-cycle, peer-based systems (every 6 weeks–3 months). HealthCo used collaboration dashboards and peer feedback; satisfaction rose 72%.

4. Managerial Lessons

Leadership Principle	Description
Trust employees to experiment	Let staff decide where AI fits; they understand their work best.

Create conditions for learning	Make learning measurable, time-protected, and rewarded.
Rethink workforce planning	Hire for adaptability and adjacent-skill growth, not fixed roles.
Reimagine leadership	Managers must enable adaptation, creativity, and collaboration.

5. Consultant’s Insights

• STEP bridges AI strategy and workforce transformation.
• It builds a learning ecosystem where employees co-evolve with AI.
• Use STEP to diagnose how AI reshapes tasks, roles, and evaluation systems.
• Practical for consulting engagements combining AI deployment, org design, and capability building.

6. Key Takeaway

“Technological change is no longer episodic — it’s continuous. Leaders who succeed teach their people how to keep learning.”

For consultants and AI strategists: Embed STEP as a governance framework for AI-enabled transformation that balances human agency, learning, and adaptive performance management.

How to Capitalize on Generative AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How to Capitalize on Generative AI’ by Andrew McAfee, Daniel Rock, and Erik Brynjolfsson (2023).

1. The Strategic Imperative

Generative AI is a general-purpose technology comparable to electricity and the internet. Its transformative impact will occur within years because digital infrastructure is already mature. Leaders must act immediately to harness its potential.

2. Case Example – AI-Augmented Customer Service

A major software firm used a hybrid LLM system (Cresta AI) to support 1,500 agents. The AI suggested replies and insights while humans retained oversight.

Metric	Improvement
Issues resolved per hour	+15%
Average chat time	–10%
Customer frustration	Reduced significantly
Productivity (least-skilled agents)	+35%
Employee turnover	Decreased, especially among new hires

Lesson: Generative AI upskilled agents rapidly—democratizing expertise and improving both performance and retention.

3. The Three-Part Process for Leaders

(1) Inventory Work and Roles: Identify tasks rather than job titles; focus on where AI can augment human output.
(2) Ask Two Key Questions: (a) How much would a competent but naive assistant help? (b) How much would an experienced assistant help if trained on firm-specific knowledge?
(3) Prioritize Projects: Rank opportunities by benefit-to-cost ratio. Start small with low-risk, high-impact use cases before scaling.

4. Managing the Risks

Risk	Safeguard / Mitigation
Confabulation (False Outputs)	Use retrieval-augmented generation, maintain human-in-the-loop verification.
Privacy	Avoid confidential data in public model training; use internal, compliant LLMs
Intellectual Property	Prefer indemnified models trained on licensed data (e.g., Adobe Firefly).
Bias	Audit model outcomes, retrain on representative datasets regularly.

5. The Agile Imperative: Experimentation and Learning

Generative AI requires continuous experimentation. Treat projects as short-cycle experiments, not long-term IT initiatives. Use agile principles—small teams, weekly iterations, reflection, and OODA loops. Build prompt engineering capability and iterate rapidly to discover scalable value.

“Rapid iteration is the best way to learn and make progress. The faster an organization experiments, the faster it benefits.”

6. Consultant’s Insights

Domain	Consultant’s View
Strategy	Treat AI as a general-purpose capability embedded in enterprise transformati
Operations	Begin with assistive, human-supervised use cases to prove ROI.
Governance	Create clear policies for truth, privacy, IP, and fairness.
Culture	Reward experimentation and prompt literacy; normalize learning.
Capability Building	Institutionalize AI adoption as an enterprise function, not an IT initiative.

7. Key Takeaway

“Generative AI’s risks can be contained—but its opportunities cannot be ignored.”

Business leaders and consultants should inventory cognitive work, pilot targeted use cases, and build hybrid human–AI systems that amplify performance, trust, and adaptability.

AI with a Human Face – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘AI with a Human Face: The Case for—and Against—Digital Employees’ by Mike Seymour et al. (2023).

1. The Opportunity

Digital humans—AI-driven, photorealistic avatars—enable organizations to combine automation efficiency with humanlike empathy. These technologies bring emotional intelligence to AI interactions, offering personalized engagement at scale.

2. What Is a Digital Human?

Digital humans simulate humanlike conversation using AI-driven faces, voices, and personalities. They outperform chatbots by incorporating facial expressions, tone, and gestures.

Example	Use Case
Soul Machines	Digital sales assistants increased online conversions by 4.5x.
Pinscreen / ZOZOtown	Digital fashion models for personalized fittings.
EY & WPP	Digital doubles for multilingual presentations.
Synthesia	Corporate videos using AI presenters.

3. When to Deploy Digital Humans

Best used when empathy and exploration matter more than speed. The following framework helps identify suitable scenarios.

Key Question	Implication
Emotional engagement?	Avatars outperform text in reassurance and empathy.
Uncertain user goals?	Conversational exploration guides discovery.
Open-ended interaction?	Ideal for experiential engagement like shopping or learning.
Personalized explanation valuable?	Perfect for demos, onboarding, and recommendations.

4. Types of Digital Humans

Type	Description	Example	Typical Use
Virtual Agent	Task-focused, one-off, no memory.	Airport guides, training bots.	Customer service.
Virtual Assistant	Personalized, task-based, ongoing relationship.	Zoey by Digital Domain.	Scheduling, therapy, education.
Virtual Influencer	Broadcast persona, engagement [illegible] personalization.	Lil Miquela, Fatima.	Brand marketing.
Virtual Companion	Deeply personal, emotional engagement.	Eldercare or tutoring companions.	Wellbeing, learning.

5. Designing Digital Humans

Success depends on design, communication, and cultural alignment.

• **Appearance & Sound:** Align avatar personality, gender, and tone with brand identity.
• **Communication Design:** Blend verbal and nonverbal cues, using real-time emotional feedback.
"Customers don't need perfection—they seek authenticity."

6. Risks and Limitations

Risk	Description
Uncanny Valley	Unnatural appearance can cause discomfort.
Context mismatch	Tone or design inconsistent with brand image.
Ethical issues	Transparency and consent are essential.
Emotional simulation	Avatars mimic but don't feel emotions.

7. Consultant's Insights

Dimension	Guidance
Strategy	Frame digital humans as an experience innovation, not automation.
Design Thinking	Ensure avatars express brand values and emotional tone.
Technology	Combine LLMs with computer vision for adaptive, multimodal interaction.
Governance	Define transparency, consent, and authenticity rules.
Change Management	Deploy gradually, tracking trust and engagement metrics.

8. Key Takeaway

"Digital humans are the next evolution of customer and employee engagement—blending AI's scale with humanity's face."

Consultants should incorporate digital humans into AI roadmaps as tools for engagement, learning, and emotional connection.

The Gen AI Playbook for Organizations – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘The Gen AI Playbook for Organizations’ by Bharat N. Anand and Andy Wu (2025).

1. Core Argument

Generative AI’s true breakthrough is accessibility, not intelligence. Like the shift from MS-DOS to Windows, it democratizes computational power by allowing everyone to interact via natural language. The winning factor isn’t speed—it’s strategic application.

2. Strategic Premises

Premise	Explanation
Act now	Waiting for perfect AI forfeits early advantage.
Value is relative	Even imperfect AI can outperform current workflows.
Advantage is distinctiveness	Use AI differently, not faster, to win.

3. Framework for Application

A 2×2 framework guides where to apply generative AI:

Axis	Description
Horizontal	Type of knowledge (explicit → tacit).
Vertical	Cost of errors (low → high).

4. The Four Zones

Zone	Description	Example Uses	Key Question
No Regrets	Low cost, explicit knowledge. Safe for early adoption.	Reimbursements, meeting summaries.	Can we tolerate minor quality loss
Creative Catalyst	Low cost, tacit knowledge. Supports exploration.	Marketing ideas, design mockups.	Can AI expand creative exploratio
Quality Control	High cost, explicit knowledge. Needs human validation.	Contract drafting, software QA.	Which steps can AI safely automa
Human-First	High cost, tacit knowledge. AI augments human judgment.	Strategy, hiring, healthcare.	How can AI enhance—not replac

5. Organizational Implications

Avoid the ‘Paradox of Access’: when all firms use gen AI similarly, efficiency gains flow to customers, not companies. Advantage arises from unique data, processes, and culture.

6. Building Competitive Advantage

Lever	Strategic Action
Access	Empower employees to experiment with gen AI.
Data	Centralize and integrate all assets as usable data.
Infrastructure	Invest in pipelines that connect proprietary data to AI.
Culture	Encourage experimentation and prompt literacy.
Organization	Redesign roles for AI-augmented workflows.

7. Redesigning the Enterprise

Reimagine assets as data, embed learning loops, and manage freed capacity proactively. Measure how AI changes not just efficiency, but strategic learning speed.

8. Consultant’s Insights

Domain	Guidance
Strategy	Compete on unique integration, not adoption speed.
Operations	Focus on augmentation—trust through collaboration.
Data Governance	Invest early in unified, proprietary data ecosystems.
Organization Design	Shift from silos to cross-functional AI workflows.
Change Management	Empower experimentation while managing risk.

9. Key Takeaways

“Generative AI’s flaws are not a reason to wait—they are a reason to strategize.”

Deploy where risk is low, pair humans with AI for quality-critical work, and compete on learning speed and data advantage.

Addressing Gen AI’s Quality-Control Problem – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Addressing Gen AI’s Quality-Control Problem’ by Stefan Thomke, Philipp Eisenhauer, and Puneet Sahni (2025).

1. Core Argument

Generative AI’s strength in creativity introduces reliability risks—fabrications, omissions, and inconsistency. Amazon’s ‘Catalog AI’ solves this by embedding automated quality control: detecting unreliable data, testing hypotheses, and improving through feedback loops.

2. The Traditional Bottleneck

Challenge	Description
Human-dependent	Manual verification across millions of listings.
Siloed models	Hundreds of ML models trained separately by category.
High cost	Specialist-intensive and hard to scale.

3. Amazon’s Four-Step Quality-Control Framework

Amazon’s approach integrates audit, guardrails, testing, and continuous learning.

Step 1: Conduct an Audit

Benchmark AI outputs against known correct data to establish baselines, error patterns, and reliability scores.

Step 2: Deploy Guardrails

Type	Purpose	Example
Simple Rules	Enforce logical consistency.	Require unit labels; block immaterial edits.
Statistical Profiles	Apply control limits (SPC-style).	Flag improbable prices or dimensions.
AI Checking AI	Reviewer LLM audits generator outputs.	Blocks weakly justified edits.

Step 3: Test Effectiveness

Integrate A/B testing across all AI content workflows to measure live performance impacts and automate feedback.

Step 4: Create a Learning System

Use simulated user models, multivariate testing, and grouped concept tests to accelerate iterative improvement.

4. Beyond Quality Control: Strategic ROI Management

Quality data enables evidence-based scaling decisions. Smaller, faster models often outperform larger ones when feedback and retraining cycles are optimized.

5. Consultant’s Insights

Domain	Guidance
AI Governance	Treat QC as continuous process control.
Architecture	Implement generator-reviewer dual-agent systems.
Measurement	Use live experimentation for every model update.
Change Management	Transition from pilots to continuous learning cycles.
Value Management	Let ROI data—not hype—guide scaling decisions.

6. Key Takeaways

“Quality is not a filter on AI output—it’s the engine of learning.”

• Scale experimentation, not headcount.
• Integrate feedback loops into workflows.
• Prioritize model retraining and ROI evidence over expansion.

Don’t Let an AI Failure Harm Your Brand – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Don’t Let an AI Failure Harm Your Brand’ by Julian De Freitas (2025).

1. Core Argument

AI failures are inevitable, but reputational damage can far exceed the technical issue. The 2023 Cruise robotaxi incident shows how poor transparency can destroy trust, even when the company is not directly at fault.

2. The Five Psychological Pitfalls

Pitfall	Description	Implications	Mitigation
People Tend to Blame AI First	Consumers hold AI to superhuman standards.	Public opinion skews toward AI blame even if not at fault.	Be transparent and share respon
When One AI Fails, Others Lose Trust	One visible failure taints all AI systems.	Sector-wide loss of confidence.	Differentiate your AI; highlight uni
Overstating Capabilities	Marketing exaggeration amplifies blame.	False expectations increase liability.	Use precise, humble claims with
Humanized AI Judged More Harshly	Anthropomorphic AIs evoke emotional backlash.	Customers feel betrayed when human-like AI fails.	Use humanization selectively and
Programmed Preferences Outrage Users	AI seen as making moral trade-offs.	Ethical backlash against biased decisions.	Avoid moral hierarchies; apply uti

3. Strategic Guidance for Marketers

Domain	Recommendation
Brand Strategy	Build expectation management into AI marketing; underpromise and overdeliver.
Crisis Response	When failure occurs, prioritize transparency and corrective action.
Differentiation	Promote your governance, safeguards, and ethical design as brand differentiators.
Governance	Involve communications and compliance early in AI product design.
Customer Experience	Align AI personality and tone with emotional context and risk sensitivity.

4. Consultant’s Insights

Area	Guidance
AI Risk Management	Embed reputational risk within AI lifecycle management.
Marketing Alignment	Ensure AI claims are consistent with technical capabilities and legal compliance.
Cross-Sector Learning	Apply best practices from high-liability sectors (aviation, finance, pharma).
Ethical Design	Avoid moral prioritization or perceived discrimination in algorithms.
Trust Recovery	Transparency and corrective actions sustain long-term brand trust.

5. Key Takeaways

“AI failure is inevitable. Brand failure is optional.”

• Consumers overestimate AI capability and underestimate uncertainty.
• Every marketing claim becomes a liability statement.
• Transparency, humility, and ethical differentiation are core to resilience.
• Plan for AI incident communication before it’s needed.

How Pioneering Boards Are Using AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How Pioneering Boards Are Using AI’ by Stanislav Shekshnia and Valery Yakubovich (2025).

1. Core Argument

Most boards still underuse AI, treating it as operational rather than strategic. AI can close directors’ information gaps, enrich discussion quality, and enhance decision-making. Leading boards are evolving from using AI as a tool, to a partner, and ultimately as a participant.

2. Reaping the Benefits

Use Case	Description	Example / Outcome
Assisting Individual Directors	AI summarizes materials, identifies patterns, and generates questions.	Director uses GPT-based assistant to test assum
Enhancing Collective Decision-Making	AI supports scenario modeling and stress-testing.	Boards use LLMs for acquisition evaluation or str
Improving Board Processes	AI analyzes meeting tone and airtime to optimize effectiveness.	AI suggests equal airtime and removes unproduc
Joining the Board	AI observers participate as advisors or ‘virtual members’.	G42’s ‘Board Navigator’ summarizes discussions

3. Managing the Risks

Risk	Description	Mitigation
Information Leaks	Confidential board data exposure through public models.	Use enterprise-secure LLMs and strict data contr
Sample Bias	AI inherits historical inequities or management bias.	Conduct audits and bias testing on AI outputs.
Anchoring in the Past	AI’s dependence on historical data limits foresight.	Deploy reasoning models and scenario simulatio

4. Learning to Use AI

Phase	Board Actions	Purpose
Create Engagement	Educate directors and discuss AI’s role.	Build curiosity and literacy.
Collective Experimentation	Pilot LLMs for agenda prep and question formulation.	Encourage experimentation and learning.
Maintain Momentum	Include AI adoption in evaluations and rewards.	Embed cultural change.

5. Strategic Implications for Governance

Area	Consultant Guidance
Board Composition	Recruit AI-literate directors and provide ongoing education.
Governance Infrastructure	Integrate AI within audit, data governance, and ethical frameworks.
Scenario Planning	Institutionalize AI-driven foresight for strategic agility.

Leadership Development	Develop chairs and directors as AI collaborators.

6. Key Takeaways

“Eventually, every board will have an AI member — perhaps even one with a vote.”

• AI helps close the information gap between directors and management.
• It enriches discussions and tests assumptions objectively.
• Success depends on culture, not just tools — AI literacy is a governance competency.
• Pioneering boards iterate through stages: engage → experiment → embed → evolve.

How Gen AI Is Transforming Market Research – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How Gen AI Is Transforming Market Research’ by Jeremy Korst, Stefano Puntoni, and Olivier Toubia (2025).

1. Core Argument

Generative AI is revolutionizing market research by replacing traditional human-based methods with synthetic data, automated insights, and digital twins. The shift accelerates research speed, scalability, and innovation.

2. Supporting Current Practices

Stage	GenAI Capability	Application	Example
Research Design	Synthesis, coding	Summarizes studies, generates hypotheses	Chatbot brainstorming with analysts
Data Collection & Analysis	Interaction, coding	Conducts interviews, sets up surveys, performs analysis	62% use GenAI for summarization
Reporting	Writing, visualization	Drafts reports and visualizations	54% use GenAI to automate report writin

3. Replacing Current Practices – Synthetic Data

Use Case	Description	Example
Simulated Audiences	Creates personas for testing products or messages	EY + Evidenza: 95% match between AI and re
Qualitative Synthesis	AI interviews synthetic respondents	Synthetic Users platform in Portugal
Proprietary Models	Private domain-specific GenAI tools	Rockfish Data’s internal AI systems

4. Filling Existing Gaps

Function	GenAI Role	Benefit
Decision Support	Runs simulations and concept tests	Data-driven decisions in hours not weeks
Market Monitoring	Analyzes competitors and trends	Continuous live ‘listening’ analytics
Product Innovation	Tests new ideas with synthetic data	General Mills uses GenAI for idea testing

5. Creating New Insights – Digital Twins

Type	Description	Example
Virtual Customers	Simulates behavior and reactions	Arena Technologies training AI
Marketing Simulation	Tests creative resonance	Ogilvy tests campaigns on digital twins
AI-Powered Assistants	Acts as personal research copilots	Oleria’s industry-trained assistants

6. Limitations and Ethical Risks

Limitation	Impact	Consultant Guidance
Bias and Representation	Models reflect developer bias	Validate outputs and randomize inputs
Emotional Blindness	AI struggles with empathy	Keep human validation in qualitative work
Overconfidence	Synthetic data may mislead	Use AI for augmentation, not substitution
Privacy	Risk of leaking proprietary data	Use enterprise-secure deployments

7. Consultant Insights for the Compendium

Area	Strategic Recommendation
Capability Building	Integrate GenAI into marketing workflows end-to-end.
Governance	Create an AI Ethics Board for market insights.
Data Strategy	Blend real and synthetic data for triangulated truth.
Organizational Design	Shift from data collection to insight orchestration.
Client Advisory	Use GenAI to simulate client reactions before workshops.

8. Key Takeaways

“AI failure is not replacing researchers — it’s redefining what insight means.”

• GenAI compresses time-to-insight from weeks to minutes.
• Synthetic data and digital twins unlock new foresight.
• Bias and ethics are strategic issues, not technical ones.
• Market research evolves from data-gathering to sense-making.

How Generative AI Improves Supply Chain Management – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How Generative AI Improves Supply Chain Management’ by Ishai Menache, Jeevan Pathuri, David Simchi-Levi, and Tom Linton (2025).

1. Core Argument

Generative AI is revolutionizing supply chain management by translating natural-language queries into analytical insights, dramatically reducing decision time, and making optimization explainable and interactive. Microsoft’s deployment across 300+ data centers demonstrates major gains in efficiency, responsiveness, and decision quality.

2. Key Capabilities and Use Cases

(a) Data Discovery and Insights

Company	Use Case	Outcome
Microsoft	LLM-generated ‘demand drift’ reports explaining plan changes	Reduced analysis time from 1 week to mi
Automotive OEM	LLM analyzed supplier contracts to find missed discounts	Millions recovered in savings

Consultant Insight: AI’s biggest value lies in explaining decisions — not just automating them.

(b) What-If Scenario Analysis

Typical Query	AI Capability
What’s the extra cost if demand rises 15%?	Re-runs optimization with adjusted demand parameters
What if Factory F closes for 7 days?	Generates updated fulfillment and cost projections
Can we meet all demand using Supplier A only?	Adds constraints and recalculates feasible plans

(c) Interactive Planning

LLMs enable planners to update models, respond to real-time events, and re-optimize plans without data-science support. The future points to natural-language-driven end-to-end optimization.

3. Overcoming Barriers

Barrier	Description	Consultant Recommendation
Adoption & Training	LLMs need precise prompts; vague inputs produce weak results.	Train planners in prompt precision; create AI-litera
Verification	LLMs may hallucinate invalid optimizations.	Use guardrails and verification scripts with fallback
Workforce Redesign	Automation shifts planners toward strategic insight.	Redefine roles for AI-collaboration and decision ov

4. Strategic Impact

Operational Transformation

Decision time reduced from days to minutes. Automated contract compliance and scenario planning strengthen cost control and resilience.

Organizational Transformation

New roles emerge: AI-literate planners, digital analysts, and AI orchestration leads integrating planning, trade, and finance.

Governance and Ethics

Implement enterprise LLMs with human oversight for high-impact decisions and ensure data sovereignty.

5. Consultant Guidance for AI Strategy Compendium

Theme	Strategic Application
AI-Driven Decision Loops	Implement plan-simulate-revise loops using LLMs for speed and clarity.
Skill Redesign	Train operations teams in prompt engineering and decision science.
Technology Stack	Combine optimization engines with conversational AI layers (e.g., Azure, SAP, Orac
Governance	Create AI control towers for verification, transparency, and auditability.
Value Realization	Measure ROI via decision speed, cost avoidance, and resilience metrics.

6. Key Takeaways

“Generative AI won’t replace planners — it will make them strategic collaborators with the machine.”

• LLMs democratize optimization and forecasting.
• AI enables human-like understanding of supply data.
• Success depends on trust, governance, and capability-building.
• Future: self-adapting, closed-loop supply networks.

Scaling Up Transformational Innovations – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Scaling Up Transformational Innovations’ by Peter Koen, Ananya Sheth, Mike DiPaola, and Linda A. Hill (Nov–Dec 2024, Reprint R2406D).

1. Core Argument

Transformational innovation redefines customer value and cost structures, yet most firms fail not in invention but in scaling. Success requires leadership engagement, team architecture, resource orchestration, and conviction-based decision-making. P&G;’s Oral-B iO and Always Infinity exemplify the transformation journey from purpose to performance.

2. The Four Challenges

A. Providing Sufficient Leadership

Leadership Principle	Description	Example / Lesson
Delegate operations	Free CEO bandwidth for transformation.	Oral Care CEO shifted focus to Oral-B iO developr
Articulate a purpose	Create emotional and strategic alignment.	Feminine Care CEO framed innovation as empowe
Set cadence of alignment	Use monthly cross-functional reviews.	iO project meetings across global functions built co

Consultant Insight: Purpose + rhythm = alignment. Without both, leadership energy dissipates before launch.

B. Building the Right Team

Role	Function	Key Insight
Integration Leader	CEO’s delegate for coordination and escalation.	Ensures senior alignment and transparency on ba
Product Owner	Drives technology and user vision.	Balances experience with innovation feasibility.
Commercial Leader	Defines market fit and pricing early.	Prevents tech-market misalignment (e.g., Google G

Best practice: form a triad of integration, product, and commercial leads under CEO or R&D; sponsorship for holistic scaling.

C. Unlocking Resources

Approach	Description	Example
Leverage corporate R&D	Access central technology and expertise.	P&G’s R&D co-developed Infinity’s materials an
Redistribute workloads	Shift incremental work to free strategic capacity.	Oral-B outsourced minor work to focus R&D on

Consultant Takeaway: Transformational innovation is not an R&D; project—it’s an enterprise reprioritization exercise.

D. Making Big-Bet Decisions

Decision Lens	Description	Example
Forward-looking metrics	Combine ROI with trend and consumer indicators.	Always Infinity’s prototypes validated premium d
Courage to be bold	Replace risk aversion with conviction-based leadership.	P&G’s CEO invested in new-to-world manufactu

Consultant Insight: Scaling requires evidence-informed conviction, not spreadsheet certainty.

3. Strategic Implications for AI Strategy and Innovation Governance

Theme	Application
Leadership Attention Economy	Treat executive time as a scarce innovation resource.
Ambidextrous Governance	Separate core and innovation units but connect through structured reviews.
Innovation Cadence Systems	Implement regular stakeholder sessions to maintain alignment.
Decision Frameworks	Use confidence maps with consumer, tech, and purpose data.
Organizational Architecture	Appoint integration leaders for AI or digital transformations.

4. Consultant Playbook for the Compendium

Area	Consultant Guidance
Client Diagnosis	Audit CEO attention allocation — is transformation visible weekly?
Design	Establish a triad: integration, product, commercial leads.
Delivery	Hold monthly cadence reviews measuring alignment and belief.
Scaling	Redistribute workloads; engage corporate innovation capital early.
Governance	Apply dual metrics: financial (lagging) and experiential (leading).

5. Key Takeaways

“Scaling transformational innovation is not about managing projects — it’s about managing belief.”

• Leadership attention determines success.
• Integration and commercial leaders are critical early.
• Orchestration across R&D;, operations, and strategy is essential.
• Success depends on conviction-driven governance, not compliance.

Embracing Gen AI at Work – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Embracing Gen AI at Work’ by H. James Wilson and Paul R. Daugherty (Sept–Oct 2024, Reprint R2405L).

1. Core Argument

Generative AI (Gen AI) is transforming professional work—impacting over 40% of U.S. job activities. Success requires employees to develop ‘fusion skills’ that combine human reasoning with machine intelligence: Intelligent Interrogation, Judgment Integration, and Reciprocal Apprenticing.

Fusion Skill	Description	Purpose
Intelligent Interrogation	Structuring prompts to elicit better reasoning from AI.	Improves quality and transparency of AI thinki
Judgment Integration	Knowing when and how to insert human discernment.	Builds trust, accuracy, and ethical reliability.
Reciprocal Apprenticing	Teaching AI about organizational context while learning from it.	Creates a symbiotic AI–human feedback loop

2. Intelligent Interrogation

Techniques to improve AI reasoning and the quality of outputs:

Technique	Description	Example / Insight
Step-by-step prompting	Add reasoning instructions to improve logical accuracy.	Boosts accuracy more than 3×; improves explai
Train in stages	Introduce tasks progressively for domain-specific learning.	Sequential tasking mirrors scientific experimenta
Explore creatively	Encourage multiple perspectives rather than binary answers.	Improves forecasting accuracy by 43%.

Consultant Insight: Prompt engineering is the new structured thinking.

3. Judgment Integration

Principle	Practice	Consulting Implication
Integrate RAG	Connect LLMs to live, authoritative data.	Critical for regulated industries (finance, healthc
Protect privacy & avoid bias	Use secure models and train users to detect bias.	Governance training ensures ethical compliance
Scrutinize suspect output	Validate using alternate models or decomposed tasks.	Multimodel checks improve reliability.

Consultant Insight: Trust is engineered through transparency and triangulation.

4. Reciprocal Apprenticing

Method	Description	Outcome
Thought demonstrations	Prime LLMs with reasoning examples.	Accuracy increased from 16% to 99% in DeepM
In-context learning	Train using contextual examples within prompts.	Rapid adaptation to corporate domains.
Reciprocal learning loop	Iteratively refine AI with user feedback.	Creates co-evolution of human and AI capability

Consultant Insight: Every prompt is a training event—for both human and machine.

5. Developing Fusion Skills at Scale

Level	Action
Individual	Practice structured prompting and evaluate outputs critically.
Team	Build AI pairing routines for collaborative output review.
Enterprise	Launch an AI literacy program for all employees.
Future Trend	Adopt agentic and multimodal AI workflows for next-gen collaboration.

6. Strategic Implications for AI Strategy

Theme	Strategic Application
AI-Human Symbiosis	Design workflows where employees act as fusion operators.
Governance Architecture	Embed privacy, bias, and retrieval controls in policy.
Capability Building	Create certification for prompt and judgment skills.
Change Management	Promote Gen AI adoption as a learning movement.
Measurement	Track results via accuracy gain, decision speed, and trust index.

7. Key Takeaways

‘The future of business will be driven not by Gen AI alone, but by the people who know how to use it most effectively.’

• AI literacy now equals professional literacy.
• Fusion skills are essential for all knowledge workers.
• Prompt engineering becomes structured thinking.
• Judgment integration builds trust and ethics.
• The next frontier: multimodal and agentic human–AI collaboration.

Boards Need a New Approach to Technology – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Boards Need a New Approach to Technology’ by Tarun Khanna, Mary C. Beckerle, and Nabil Y. Sakkab (Sept–Oct 2024, Reprint R2405J).

1. Core Thesis

Boards have focused too narrowly on IT and cybersecurity risk, overlooking wider opportunities in AI, materials science, and genomics. To stay competitive, they must institutionalize Technology Committees (TechComs) that guide innovation, risk appetite, and scientific engagement.

Primary Functions of Tech Committees	Description
Scan & Prioritize	Systematically identify and monitor emerging technologies via a 'technology rad
Embrace Risk	Treat technology as a strategic bet, not a compliance concern.
Shepherd Core Technologies	Guide long-horizon R&D and cross-sector collaboration.
Educate & Counsel	Enhance board understanding of technology and its business impact.

2. Case Studies

AES (Energy): Created a Technology Committee integrating renewables and grid-scale storage; led to Fluence Energy JV with Siemens.
Johnson & Johnson (Healthcare): Science & Technology Committee bridges medtech and pharma innovation through JLABS and oncology partnerships.
Altria (Consumer Goods): Innovation Committee guided transition to non-combustion nicotine and harm reduction products.
Dassault Systèmes (Industrial Software): Scientific Committee oversees 20-year roadmap on AI, virtual twins, and biosciences.

3. Governance Design Principles

Dimension	Guidance
Mandate	Focus on opportunity-seeking and long-term science engagement.
Composition	Include technologists, scientists, and business 'translators'.
Agenda	Cover R&D progress, deep dives, and external expert input.
Interface	Foster tight collaboration with CTOs and CSOs ('interlaced fingers').
Culture	Encourage curiosity and balance ambition with commercial discipline.

4. Global Context

• Only 36% of Fortune 100 and 20% of Fortune 500 firms currently have technology committees (as of 2024).
• Europe lags behind at less than 25% of large-cap firms.
• Rapid trend toward formal TechComs as strategic governance mechanisms.

5. Implications for AI Strategy

Theme	Strategic Implication
AI in Broader Context	Boards must treat AI as one vector in a wider technology-science landscape.
Cross-Disciplinary Oversight	Establish governance across ethics, data, economics, and life sciences.
Institutionalization	Formalize AI discussions at board level via a Technology or Innovation Committee.
Strategic Framing	Shift from risk management to opportunity discovery and innovation acceleration.

6. Compendium Fit

Section: Governance & Leadership for AI
Subsection: Strategic Oversight and Board Enablement
Use Case: Framework for board-level integration of AI and emerging technologies.

7. Key Takeaways

• Boards must move from defensive oversight to proactive innovation.
• Technology Committees can institutionalize science-driven governance.
• AI should be framed as part of a broader technology evolution.
• Effective governance requires multidisciplinary expertise and foresight.
‘Technology is not a threat to be contained, but a frontier to be governed.’

How AI Can Power Brand Management – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How AI Can Power Brand Management’ by Julian De Freitas and Elie Ofek (Sept–Oct 2024, Reprint R2405G).

1. Core Thesis

AI is transforming brand management by augmenting creativity and automating complex marketing and operational processes. Leading firms use AI to reinforce brand promise, deepen customer relationships, and ensure technology complements human authenticity.

2. The Four Ps of AI’s Brand Impact

P	Definition	Strategic Contribution to Brand Equity
Productivity	AI enhances efficiency and quality in marketing and service delivery.	Reduces cost and friction while improving customer expe
Prediction	AI anticipates customer needs or failures.	Builds trust and reliability through proactive service.
Personalization	AI tailors content and experiences.	Creates relevance, loyalty, and emotional engagement.
Proposals	AI generates creative ideas aligned with brand tone.	Scales creativity while maintaining brand identity.

3. Case Studies Illustrating the Four Ps

Intuit (Productivity): Used AI to analyze customer service transcripts and enhance agent performance, improving both efficiency and satisfaction.
Caterpillar/Borusan Cat (Prediction): Achieved 97% accuracy in predictive maintenance and built reliability-based contracts.
LOOP Insurance (Personalization): Used telematics to create fair, transparent, real-time pricing—positioning itself as ethical and empowering.
Jasper AI (Proposals): Deployed multiple LLMs with data controls to create consistent branded content at scale.

4. Key Insights for Consultants and Strategists

• AI and human creativity complement one another.
• Over-automation risks eroding authenticity.
• Brands must define AI’s role in their promise.
• Co-design processes reduce internal resistance.
• Use the Four Ps as a diagnostic for AI–brand alignment.

5. Implications for AI Strategy

Theme	Strategic Action
AI–Human Collaboration	Position AI as a creative co-pilot guided by human intuition.
Trust & Transparency	Use AI to make reliability and fairness visible.
Ethical Design	Avoid bias; align personalization with fairness.

Data Governance	Protect proprietary brand data and customer privacy.
Brand Measurement	Track trust, engagement, and emotional resonance alongside efficiency.

6. Compendium Placement

Section: Marketing & Customer Engagement
Subsection: AI-Enhanced Brand Management
Use Case: Integrating Generative and Predictive AI to Balance Efficiency, Creativity, and Authenticity.

7. Key Takeaways

• AI strengthens brand equity when aligned with human creativity.
• Successful AI integration balances automation with empathy.
• Brand differentiation in the AI era depends on responsible innovation.
‘AI must amplify the human voice of the brand—not replace it.’

AI Won’t Give You a New Sustainable Advantage – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘AI Won’t Give You a New Sustainable Advantage’ by Jay B. Barney and Martin Reeves (Sept–Oct 2024, Reprint R2405C).

1. Core Thesis

Generative AI will transform business models and productivity but will not, by itself, create a sustainable competitive advantage. Like electricity or the internet, its benefits diffuse quickly across competitors. Firms win by applying AI to amplify unique capabilities they already own.

2. Value Creation ≠ Value Capture

Concept	Insight
Efficiency Gains	AI lowers cost and boosts productivity, but these gains are easily replicated.
Innovation Support	AI generates ideas, but competitors can reach similar outcomes with similar data.
Learning Feedback	AI systems learn from shared data; competitive lead quickly erodes.

3. Proprietary Data Is Not a Panacea

Potential Advantage	Why It Fails to Last
Unique Data Sets	Competitors often possess functionally similar data.
Large Data Volumes	Returns diminish once models learn common patterns.
Private Data	Data breaches and inference risks reduce exclusivity.

4. The Silver Lining – Leverage Existing Advantages

AI amplifies firms’ existing strengths. Companies with rare, integrated resources (e.g., Amazon’s ecosystem) can use AI to multiply their edge. Firms without unique assets may only achieve parity, not leadership.

5. Toward AI-Native Business Models

Temporary advantage arises when AI is embedded in organizational architecture—driving feedback loops, learning, and self-optimization. However, few firms achieve this comprehensively, and governance challenges remain significant.

6. Strategic Implications for Consultants & Executives

Theme	Guidance
Competitive Realism	Treat AI as a capability amplifier, not a moat.
Strategic Focus	Invest where AI strengthens unique assets—culture, data, ecosystem.

Capability Building	Enhance agility and learning speed to apply AI faster than rivals.
AI Governance	Prioritize ethical use, data protection, and stakeholder trust.

7. Compendium Placement

Section: Strategic Foundations of AI Advantage
Subsection: Competitive Strategy & Sustainability
Use Case: Understanding AI as a general-purpose technology that enhances—but rarely creates—competitive advantage.

8. Key Takeaways

• AI reshapes industries but doesn’t guarantee durable advantage.
• Sustainable differentiation comes from unique resource application.
• First-mover edge fades quickly—execution speed and integration matter most.
• Build AI-amplified capabilities: rare, valuable, and hard to imitate.
‘Those who already have an edge will find AI sharpens it.’

The Promise and Peril of AI at Work – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘The Promise and Peril of AI at Work’ by Eben Harrell (July–August 2024, Reprint R2404N).

1. Core Thesis

Artificial intelligence offers immense potential and real risk for human productivity. Recent thinkers split between two visions: one of practical human-AI collaboration and one of existential transformation. The outcome depends on how humans choose to engage—with AI as a tool, partner, or master.

2. The 'Co-Intelligence' Paradigm (Ethan Mollick)

Principle	Description
Invite AI to the Table	Experiment broadly with AI to uncover value.
Be the Human in the Loop	Guide outputs, ensuring context and quality.
Treat AI Like an Intern	Direct, correct, and supervise AI actively.
Assume This Is the Worst AI You’ll Use	Expect rapid improvement; keep adapting.

Evidence from BCG shows consultants trained to use AI outperform peers in speed, creativity, and analysis.

3. The Singularity Vision (Ray Kurzweil)

Kurzweil envisions a near-future fusion of human and artificial cognition: nanobots repairing ecosystems, digital replicants, and an exponential intelligence explosion. Critics interpret this as technological mysticism rather than science.

4. The Practical Enterprise View (Daniela Rus & Gregory Mone)

Their book ‘The Mind’s Mirror’ emphasizes organizational readiness: build clear data strategies, maintain fairness, and establish feedback loops for trust. The goal is empowerment, not replacement.

5. The Humanist Counterpoint (Cal Newport)

In ‘Slow Productivity,’ Newport argues that the human mind’s deep creativity thrives on time and focus, not constant acceleration. AI should enhance, not erode, this balance.

6. Synthesis: Between Urgency and Humanity

Theme	Strategic Insight
Empowerment	AI augments knowledge work but needs human judgment.

Balance	Adoption speed must align with cognitive and ethical limits.
Ethics	Transparency and oversight sustain trust.
Learning	Experiment continuously; learn through guided practice.

7. Compendium Placement

Section: Human–AI Collaboration and the Future of Work
Subsection: Productivity, Creativity, and Co-Intelligence
Use Case: Guiding executives and teams to integrate AI responsibly and collaboratively.

8. Key Takeaways

• AI’s potential depends on quality of human partnership.
• Productivity must balance speed and sustainability.
• Ethical design and feedback loops ensure fairness.
• Professionals should gain real experience through experimentation.
‘Perhaps we need fewer sleepless nights driven by technological urgency, not more.’

Heavy Machinery Meets AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Heavy Machinery Meets AI’ by Vijay Govindarajan and Venkat Venkatraman (March–April 2024, Reprint R2402G).

1. Core Thesis

The convergence of digital intelligence and industrial machinery is redefining competitive advantage. Manufacturers must evolve from physical product competition to fusion strategy—integrating hardware, software, data, and AI into adaptive, insight-driven systems.

2. What Is Fusion Strategy?

Comparison	Internet of Things	Fusion Strategy
Focus	Monitoring and data collection	Continuous insight generation and adaptation
Ownership	Functional (IT, Engineering)	Cross-functional and strategic
Goal	Operational efficiency	Competitive differentiation through intelligence
Scope	Product-level	System- and ecosystem-level
Tempo	Linear	Real-time and exponential

Winners will not be those with the best machinery, but those generating the deepest, fastest insights from physical–digital integration.

3. The Four Fusion Strategies

A. Fusion Products: Designed to analyze product-in-use data and act in real time. Examples include Tesla’s three digital twins and Deere’s AI-powered 'See & Spray' system.
B. Fusion Services: Moves from manual and reactive to predictive and proactive, like Rolls-Royce’s R² Data Labs optimizing aircraft performance.
C. Fusion Systems: Integrates diverse products into intelligent ecosystems, as seen with Honeywell’s AI-managed Burj Khalifa operations.
D. Fusion Solutions: Combines fusion products, services, and systems to deliver holistic customer outcomes, e.g., Deere’s Granular software for predictive agriculture.

4. Traditional vs. Fusion Strategy

Dimension	Traditional	Fusion
Growth	Linear, within industry	Exponential, across industries
Advantage	Physical assets	Information and data insights
Integration	Vertical (M&A)	Virtual (ecosystem partnerships)
Customer Insights	At point-of-sale	Continuous product-in-use data
Data Use	Efficiency focus	Strategic differentiation

5. Leadership Imperatives

• CEOs must lead digital transformation directly.
• Align data, AI, and operational capabilities in a unified roadmap.
• Build ecosystems through partnerships, not vertical control.
• Promote human–machine collaboration to accelerate learning.
• Adopt outcome-based contracts aligned with customer success.

6. Compendium Placement

Section: Industrial Transformation and the AI-Enabled Enterprise
Subsection: Fusion Strategy and Real-Time Intelligence
Use Case: Framework for integrating AI, data, and physical assets to create next-generation industrial value networks.

7. Key Takeaways

• Fusion of steel and silicon defines modern industrial advantage.
• Competitive edge comes from turning data into insight faster.
• Fusion strategies span products, services, systems, and ecosystems.
• Real-time AI transforms machines into learning, adaptive assets.
‘Every function and process can be enhanced if humans and machines work together.’

Turn Generative AI from an Existential Threat into a Competitive Advantage

Based on Harvard Business Review article by Scott Cook, Andrei Hagiu, and Julian Wright (Jan–Feb 2024, Reprint R2401J).

1. Core Thesis

Generative AI lowers the cost of creativity and problem-solving. It threatens firms dependent on human-generated output, but offers new paths to advantage for those that integrate it strategically through proprietary feedback loops that drive continuous improvement.

2. Three Levels of Generative AI Adoption

Level	Description	Example Applications	Competitive Outcome
1 – Adopt Public Tools	Use off-the-shelf models for research, writing, and analysis.	Consultants, lawyers, and creatives using ChatGPT and Midjourney.	Temporary speed and cost advantag
2 – Customize the Tools	Fine-tune on proprietary data for specialized results.	AI chatbots for banking, internal process assistants.	Sustainable differentiation via tailored
3 – Continuous Feedback Loops	Build self-learning systems from user interaction.	Adaptive learning tutors, auto-improving services.	Compounding competitive advantage

3. Implementation Considerations

• Protect proprietary data when using public models.
• Fine-tune to align outputs with company standards.
• Re-engineer workflows to capture natural user feedback.
• Leverage open-source LLMs for cost-effective customization.

4. Sector Impact

Sector Type	Impact	Strategic Response
Consumer Goods	Low disruption – marketing and innovation enhancement.	Level 1
Software Firms	High risk for UI-heavy products; integrated platforms fare better.	Level 2 $\rightarrow$ 3
Education & Design Services	Immediate disruption by automation.	Level 3 urgently
Customer Service	Major opportunity for efficiency and personalization.	Level 2 $\rightarrow$ 3

5. Diagnostic Questions

1. How much of our offering could AI replace?
2. How unique and defensible is our data?
3. How reliable are our feedback mechanisms?
4. How costly is it to collect ongoing feedback?

6. Leadership Imperatives

• Treat AI as a strategic differentiator, not a productivity add-on.
• Build organization-wide AI literacy and ownership.
• Prioritize data feedback architecture over generic AI adoption.
• Enforce ethical and security guardrails around proprietary data.

7. Compendium Placement

Section: AI Transformation and Strategic Advantage
Subsection: Generative AI Maturity & Capability Models
Use Case: Executive framework to transition from ad-hoc AI use to self-improving systems.

8. Key Takeaways

• Competitive advantage in AI lies in proprietary feedback loops.
• Unique data enables lasting differentiation.
• Generative AI must be treated as core strategy.
• Leadership commitment determines success.

“The firms best placed to achieve durable advantage are those with access to unique customer data that can be continuously replenished via self-reinforcing feedback loops.”

Leading in a World Where AI Wields Power of Its Own – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Leading in a World Where AI Wields Power of Its Own’ by Jeremy Heimans and Henry Timms (Jan–Feb 2024, Reprint R2401D).

1. Core Thesis

AI has entered the age of autosapience — systems that act, learn, and influence with growing independence. These autosapient agents reshape how power, trust, and accountability function in organizations and society. Leaders must adapt to collaborate with these systems while preserving human agency and moral authority.

2. The Four Traits of Autosapient Systems

Trait	Definition	Implications
Agentic	Act autonomously to execute complex, multistage tasks.	Can create or solve crises; demands oversight.
Adaptive	Learn from experience and improve without human input.	Drives discovery but reduces predictability.
Amiable	Build emotional rapport and simulate empathy.	Increases engagement but risks emotional dependence.
Arcane	Opaque decision-making (‘black box’ systems).	Creates power through mystery, weakens accountability.

3. Shifting Power Dynamics

Domain	Transformation	Leadership Challenge
Ideas & Information Flow	From open networks to concentrated control by a few AI platforms.	Maintain diverse data sources and voices.
Expertise	Human authority displaced by autosapient ‘teachers’ and advisors.	Reassert human creativity and judgment.
Value Creation	AI lowers entry barriers and redistributes innovation.	Harness new entrants while preserving equity.
Human–Tech Relationship	Integration of AI into daily cognition and emotion.	Protect privacy and authenticity.
Governance	AI shaping laws and norms via automated influence.	Design for explainability and accountability.

4. Leadership Lessons for the Autosapient Era

- **Learn to Duet — and Doubt:** Treat AI as a partner but challenge its assumptions.
- **Seek a ‘Return on Humanity’:** Compete on authenticity, empathy, and creative depth.
- **Don’t Straddle the Divide:** Choose a clear stance on AI ethics — it’s the new ESG frontier.

5. Strategic Implications

- AI now shares agency with humans — governance must evolve.
- Power will centralize around those controlling models and data.
- Leadership must blend technological fluency with moral courage.
- Human judgment, trust-building, and synthesis become core differentiators.

6. Compendium Placement

Section: AI Leadership and Organizational Futures
Subsection: Human–Machine Power Dynamics
Use Case: Framework for CEOs and policymakers to navigate the governance and ethical challenges of autonomous AI.

7. Key Takeaways

- AI is evolving from tool to actor — autonomy demands new oversight.
- Model ownership defines modern power structures.
- Ethical alignment is a strategic differentiator.
- Leadership means managing collaboration with systems that can lead themselves.

“Can we lead systems that can lead themselves?”

How AI Affects Our Sense of Self – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How AI Affects Our Sense of Self’ by Gizem Yalcin and Stefano Puntoni (Sept–Oct 2023, Reprint R2305K).

1. Core Thesis

AI is reshaping not only business processes but also human identity and self-worth. As automation expands, organizations must account for how people feel about their role, agency, and contribution in AI-enabled environments. Successful systems enhance human dignity and ownership rather than replacing them.

2. Services and Business-Process Design

Finding	Insight	Strategic Implication
Positive AI decisions evoke less joy than human ones.	AI decisions reduce sense of recognition and agency.	Use humans to deliver good news; AI can handl
Rejection by AI or human is equally disliked.	Blame is external in both cases.	Human touch unnecessary for negative outcome
Human oversight must be active, not symbolic.	Visibility of empathy matters more than mere presence.	Ensure humans visibly shape final judgments.

AI should streamline routine judgment while reserving human participation for moments that affect identity — recognition, validation, or success.

3. Product Design and Identity

Phenomenon	Impact	Managerial Response
Automation of identity-linked activities (e.g., cooking, cycling).	Users feel less ownership and pride.	Preserve visible human contribution in design.
Symbolic products lose emotional value when automated.	Diminished identity expression.	Emphasize craftsmanship and personalization.
Ease can feel like 'cheating'.	Automation reduces perceived skill.	Balance convenience with challenge to retain pr

Avoid full automation in identity-sensitive products; instead, design collaborative experiences that amplify human skill and creativity.

4. Communication and Framing

Principle	Evidence	Application
Humanize AI interfaces.	Naming or avatar use improves acceptance.	Give AI a persona (e.g., 'Sam' not 'System 47').
Frame AI as a partner, not replacement.	Users respond better when AI assists their skills.	Use collaborative language in messaging.
Protect professional identity.	Workers fear skill devaluation.	Emphasize augmentation, not automation.

Communicate AI as empowerment: 'You + AI = Better Outcomes.' Human framing drives engagement and trust.

5. Strategic Implications for Leaders

• AI adoption barriers are psychological as much as technical.
• Systems must align with how people perceive their roles and dignity.
• Measure AI success not just in productivity but in preserved human agency.
• Ask: How does our AI make people feel about themselves?

6. Compendium Placement

Section: AI Transformation and Human Psychology
Subsection: Identity, Emotion, and Adoption Barriers
Use Case: Framework for designing AI systems and communications that enhance self-worth and engagement.

7. Key Takeaways

• AI shapes how people see themselves, not just how they work.
• Over-automation erodes meaning and pride.
• Preserve human authorship in AI experiences.
‘The true test of AI design is whether it makes people feel more, not less, human.’

Reskilling in the Age of AI – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘Reskilling in the Age of AI’ by Jorge Tamayo, Leila Doumi, Sagar Goel, Orsolya Kovács-Ondrejkovic, and Raffaella Sadun (Sept–Oct 2023, Reprint R2305C).

1. Core Thesis

AI and automation are transforming job structures faster than organizations can adapt. With the half-life of skills now under five years, reskilling must shift from a tactical HR activity to a strategic driver of competitiveness, inclusion, and innovation.

2. Reskilling as a Strategic Imperative

Driver	Example	Strategic Implication
Workforce evolution	Infosys trained 2,000+ cybersecurity experts; Vodafone fills 40% of dev roles internally.	Builds future-ready skills in-house.
Career mobility	Mahindra, Wipro, Ericsson, and McDonald’s offer internal job pathways.	Retains adaptable, loyal talent.
Inclusion	ICICI Bank and CVS train diverse cohorts for frontline and cross-roles.	Expands workforce diversity and resilience.

Reskilling is now a strategic investment in agility and capacity—not just cost avoidance.

3. Reskilling as Leadership Responsibility

Reskilling must be embedded in leadership KPIs and governance. Examples include Ericsson’s AI upskilling of 15,000 employees and Amazon’s inclusion of talent development in leadership reviews. Accountability ensures alignment between transformation goals and workforce readiness.

4. Reskilling as Change Management

Dimension	Example
Skill Taxonomies	HSBC uses WEF frameworks; SAP partners with Lightcast.
Strategic Workforce Planning	Allianz models talent needs through AI scenarios.
Recruitment & Evaluation	Novartis’ internal AI job-matching marketplace.
Manager Mindset	Wipro and Amazon reward talent mobility.
Learning in the Flow of Work	ICICI Bank uses simulations for job transitions.
Integration Post-Reskilling	Amazon’s mentoring for reskilled employees.

Successful reskilling aligns data, structure, and culture to make learning part of daily operations.

5. Employees Want to Reskill — When It Makes Sense

Employees embrace reskilling when they see clear personal benefit and fairness. Organizations must provide transparency, financial support, and time to learn.

Principle	Practice
Partnership	Involve employees and unions early in program design.
Design for Empathy	Amazon’s Career Choice pre-pays education; CVS offers 'train-in-place.'
Protected Time	Vodafone reserves learning days; Bosch pays for training hours.
Equity	Iberdrola compensates hourly staff for learning participation.

6. Reskilling Takes a Village

True reskilling success depends on public–private collaboration. Industry, academia, and civil institutions must jointly redefine skill pathways.

Ecosystem Actor	Example	Purpose
Industry alliances	EU Automotive Skills Alliance; Singapore IBF	Develop shared standards and certifications.
Nonprofit partnerships	OneTen, Year Up, Joblinge.	Expand reach and inclusion.
Academic/Public partnerships	UK Institutes of Technology; BMW–German Chambers.	Accelerate adaptation to technological change.

7. Strategic Implications for AI Leaders

• Reskilling must be continuous, data-driven, and measurable.
• Treat workforce skills as a living portfolio.
• Empower managers as career architects, not gatekeepers.
• Build learning ecosystems that evolve with AI and automation.

8. Compendium Placement

Section: Human Capital & AI-Enabled Transformation
Subsection: Workforce Strategy & Organizational Design
Use Case: Framework for enterprise reskilling and workforce adaptability in the AI era.

9. Key Takeaways

• Reskilling is the new core competency for AI-era organizations.
• Success depends on leadership ownership, structural alignment, and trust.
• The defining question: *‘Can our organization learn faster than AI changes the game?’*

How Generative AI Can Augment Human Creativity – Summary for AI Strategy Compendium

Based on Harvard Business Review article ‘How Generative AI Can Augment Human Creativity’ by Tojin T. Eapen, Daniel J. Finkenstadt, Josh Folk, and Lokesh Venkataswamy (July–Aug 2023, Reprint R2304C).

1. Core Thesis

Generative AI enhances, rather than replaces, human creativity by expanding divergent thinking — the ability to generate varied, novel ideas. It democratizes innovation by overcoming barriers like expertise bias, idea overload, and limited collaboration. The technology’s greatest value lies in supporting human imagination, exploration, and co-creation.

2. The Five Ways Generative AI Enhances Creativity

Capability	AI Role	Example
Promote Divergent Thinking	Generates novel combinations and analogies to inspire ideation.	Midjourney merges 'elephant' and 'butterfly' into produc
Challenge Expertise Bias	Breaks fixation by producing unexpected forms and concepts.	Stable Diffusion outputs crab-like toys, expanding crea
Assist in Idea Evaluation	Assesses ideas on novelty, feasibility, and impact metrics.	ChatGPT ranks food-waste reduction ideas for creative
Support Idea Refinement	Synthesizes multiple ideas into stronger hybrid concepts.	AI merges sustainability ideas into integrated action pla
Facilitate Collaboration	Enables distributed, real-time co-creation among teams and users.	ChatGPT and Stable Diffusion co-design 'flying automo

3. Key Insights

• AI enhances the creative process, not just its output.
• Democratizes innovation by giving non-experts access to design exploration tools.
• Overcomes cognitive traps like functional fixedness by introducing analogical variety.
• Enables scalable idea evaluation and ranking in crowdsourced environments.
• Fosters global, AI-enabled collaboration between creators, customers, and communities.

4. Strategic Implications for AI Leaders

• Integrate AI tools into innovation pipelines to amplify creative capacity.
• Treat AI as a co-creator capable of suggesting, evaluating, and refining ideas.
• Build AI literacy around design thinking and analogical reasoning.
• Use AI to accelerate iteration cycles and support creative equity across teams.
• Frame AI-enabled creativity as a competitive differentiator, not just efficiency gain.

5. Compendium Placement

Section: Human–AI Collaboration & Innovation
Subsection: Creative Intelligence and Design Thinking
Use Case: Framework for augmenting organizational creativity and democratizing innovation through AI-enabled collaboration.

6. Key Takeaways

• Generative AI expands human imagination through collaboration and iteration.
• True creative advantage lies in co-creation between humans and machines.
• Leaders must design ecosystems where AI amplifies rather than automates innovation.

“Generative AI’s greatest potential is not replacing humans—it is assisting them in creating hitherto unimaginable solutions.”

Stop Tinkering with AI

Thomas H. Davenport & Nitin Mittal — Harvard Business Review (Jan–Feb 2023, R2301J)

■ Core Thesis

Most companies are dabbling in AI through pilots and isolated use cases, but few achieve large-scale transformation. True value comes from embedding AI throughout the organization, reimagining workflows, and building a data-driven culture.

■ Ten Actions of Successful AI Adopters

#	Action	Description	Example
1	Know What You Want to Accomplish	Start with a clear AI objective tied to strategy.	Deloitte – Omnia AI platform for audit quality.
2	Work with an Ecosystem of Partners	Collaborate to accelerate innovation.	Deloitte with Kira Systems, Signal AI, Chatterbox La
3	Master Analytics	Analytics excellence as AI foundation.	Seagate automated inspections, halving defects.
4	Create a Modular IT Architecture	Use cloud-native, flexible infrastructure.	Capital One migrated entirely to AWS.
5	Integrate AI into Workflows	Embed AI into daily processes.	NASA, SSA automated HR and adjudication workflo
6	Build Solutions Across the Organization	Scale AI models horizontally.	Cleveland Clinic risk scoring and preventive care.
7	Create AI Governance & Leadership	Formalize accountability and leadership.	Led from the top with executive sponsorship.
8	Develop Centers of Excellence	Build internal AI fluency and teams.	DBS Bank retrained staff and doubled engineers.
9	Invest Continually	Treat AI as a capital investment.	CCC Intelligent Solutions invests $100M+ annually.
10	Seek New Data Sources	Expand proprietary data assets.	CCC used smartphone imagery for auto-claims.

■ Strategic Insights for the AI Strategy Compendium

- Transformation requires scale—pilots don’t create value.
- Data is the new moat—structured, proprietary data drives differentiation.
- Architecture matters—cloud-native modular systems accelerate adoption.
- Culture is decisive—AI success needs trust and literacy.
- Governance is critical—bias checks and ethical frameworks sustain progress.

■ Key Takeaways for AI Leaders

- Think beyond experiments—AI must permeate products and operations.
- Build an AI ecosystem of partners, cloud, and talent.
- Leadership must fund and champion AI visibly.
- Deep, structural AI commitment defines future competition.

“Artificial intelligence is here to stay. Companies that apply it vigorously will dominate their industries over the next several decades.” — Davenport & Mittal

■ Placement in Compendium

Section: AI Transformation Strategy
Subsection: Enterprise-Scale Adoption and AI Leadership
Use Case: Transitioning from pilots to enterprise integration

How AI Is Redefining Managerial Roles

Ana Moreno — Harvard Business Review (July–Aug 2025, F2504A)

■ Core Thesis

Generative AI is reshaping the role of middle management by automating coordination, reporting, and supervision tasks. This shift enables flatter organizations where managers focus on creativity, strategy, and human leadership rather than oversight.

■ Research Basis

Study: 'Generative AI and the Nature of Work' (Hoffmann et al., 2024) examined 50,032 software developers (half using GitHub Copilot), tracking 2.4 million actions. Copilot users spent 5% more time on core tasks (coding) and 10% less on management tasks, showing that AI reduces coordination needs and increases autonomy.

■ Findings and Mechanisms

Insight	Description	Organizational Implication
Autonomy increases	AI tools reduce dependence on managers for problem-solving.	Flatter structures and self-directed teams.
Less coordination required	AI automates scheduling, checking, and communication.	Fewer managerial layers needed.
Skill equalization	Lower-skilled employees gain from AI augmentation.	Managers shift from supervision to innovation.
Enhanced productivity	Managers freed from admin tasks contribute more strategically.	Higher engagement and throughput.

■■ Strategic Imperatives

1. Determine What to Automate
• Audit managerial tasks to classify project management vs. core work.
• Automate coordination-heavy functions using AI.
• Reinvest managerial time in creativity, engagement, and improvement.

2. Determine Who Benefits Most
• Identify roles (often junior) that gain most from AI augmentation.
• Redirect managerial effort to innovation and talent development.

■ Industry Perspective: KPMG Case Study

Observation	Detail
Flattening trend	Shift toward a skills-based workforce reducing hierarchical roles.
Associates upskilling	AI allows associates to prepare for meetings at managerial level.
Managers moving upward	Middle managers engage in executive-level problem-solving.
AI as equalizer	Enables rapid self-training and task execution.
Human edge retained	Managers remain essential for empathy and communication.

■ Implications for AI Strategy

• Flatter organizations with fewer managerial tiers are emerging.
• AI-driven autonomy redefines management as enablement, not oversight.
• Human-centric leadership becomes a key differentiator (empathy, narrative framing).
• AI access reduces skill gaps, requiring reimagined leadership and workforce models.

■ Placement in Compendium

Section: AI and Organizational Design
Subsection: AI-Augmented Leadership and Structural Transformation
Use Case: Redefining managerial roles and hierarchies through AI-driven autonomy.

Don’t Let Gen AI Limit Your Team’s Creativity

Kian Gohar & Jeremy Utley — Harvard Business Review (Mar–Apr 2024, F2402A)

■ Core Thesis

Generative AI can accelerate brainstorming—but when used uncritically, it narrows creativity. Teams that treat AI as an oracle get average answers; those that treat it as a conversation partner achieve richer, more original results.

■ Research Overview

Four-company experiment (US & Europe) with 60 employees per firm solving real business challenges. Teams using AI generated slightly more ideas but fewer high-quality ones, showing how overreliance on AI reduces creative variance.

Measure	AI Teams vs Control	Insight
Idea quantity	+8%	AI boosts idea count slightly.
High-quality ideas	–2%	Slight creativity decline due to convergence.
Poor ideas	–7%	AI filters out bad ideas but limits novelty.
Confidence	+21%	False confidence from polished but shallow output.

■ Why Teams Underperformed

• Generic prompts produced average, statistically common ideas.
• Teams accepted AI’s first outputs, showing premature convergence.
• Few teams iterated critically with the AI to challenge results.
• False confidence made teams believe quality improved when it hadn’t.

■ Prescriptions for Creative Success

Principle	Practical Action
Define specific problems	Frame detailed, data-rich prompts to avoid generic AI results.
Start with human ideation	Brainstorm individually before using AI to expand options.
Train the AI contextually	Feed it domain data, customer insights, and prior lessons.
Dialogue, don’t delegate	Treat AI as a sparring partner through iterative conversation.
Facilitate synthesis	Use moderation to ensure idea diversity and balance.

■■ Practitioner Insight — Joe Riesberg (CIO, EMC Insurance)

“The more you question generative AI, the better its answers will be.” Initial responses tend to be logical rather than creative. Teams that persist through multiple prompt iterations unlock deeper and more original insights.

■ Placement in Compendium

Section: Human–AI Collaboration and Innovation
Subsection: Creative Intelligence & Design Thinking
Use Case: Structuring AI-assisted ideation workflows to maximize originality while avoiding average outcomes.

■ Key Takeaways

• AI boosts idea volume but can suppress creativity.
• Treat AI as a collaborator, not a content generator.
• Iteration and specificity are key to unlocking creative value.
• Human facilitation ensures diversity of thought and originality.

“Brainstorming with GenAI requires rethinking your ideation workflow. Approach it as a structured, ongoing conversation—and you’ll unlock truly creative outcomes.”